

SAFE HAVEN TIMES

Summer 2026



Six Hundred Cats & Counting

Just over a year ago, Safe Haven opened a low-cost spay and neuter clinic with great hopes of reducing the overpopulation of dogs and cats in northwest Illinois – with a strong emphasis on cats - and to provide a lower cost of services to help those in need afford the procedures. To date, 600 community cats from as far away as Ridott and Savanna have been served during day-long clinics at the shelter. ***Statistically, these cats could have produced 600,000 other cats if they had not been sterilized. This is a staggering number.***

The low-cost clinic is staffed by an outstanding group of professionals and volunteers who show up for workdays that last from six to ten hours. "We had some bumps and bruises along the

way, but the clinic operation has been blessed with a very dedicated group of volunteers and a wonderful veterinarian in Dr. Coulson. Other veterinarians have also participated, and we have had significant contributions from a number of vet techs. What this group has been able to accomplish is inspiring. It is very heartwarming to see the gratitude expressed by clients who have such a love for these beautiful creatures," says Sam Smith, Safe Haven Board President.

Currently, the clinic runs three days a month and new volunteers with some relevant experience are welcome to join. Community members who wish to have cats spayed or neutered can call Safe Haven or email safehaven1471@gmail.com. Clinic days will expand as funding allows.



The clinic crew at a well deserved one-year celebratory dinner. The clinic team from left to right is Jamie Whitmer, Nancy Boop, Andrea Heidenreich, Amanda Kevern, Mary Hofer Furlong, Jen Berendes, Rachel O'Brien, Danielle Miller, Katie Hoffman, Brooke Bernard, Sam Smith, and Dr. Dulce Coulson.

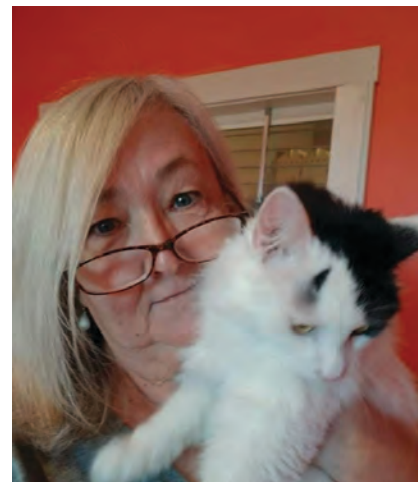
Our Amazing Team!



Jeannette Thraen McCullum
Shelter Manager



Anne Marie James
Bookkeeper



Cher Dyle
Volunteer Coordinator



Taylor Edler
Veterinary Assistant



Amanda Kautz
Assistant Manager



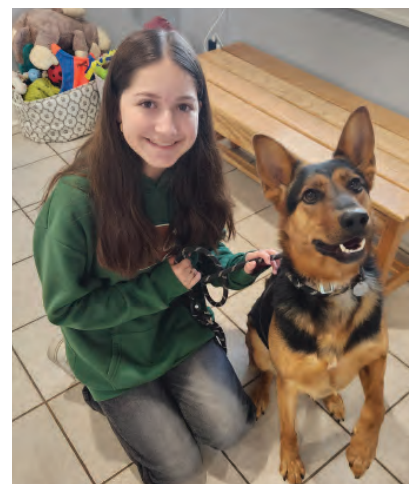
Andrew Roos Barlow
Shelter Assistant



Kristin Roos Barlow
Shelter Assistant



Wendy Marcotte
Shelter Assistant



Allie Velazquez
Shelter Assistant

From the President

PETS ARE GOOD FOR PEOPLE

Pet owners generally view the animals in their homes as a part of the family. While companionship alone can be very valuable, there are many health benefits that are often gained through pet ownership.

Clinical studies have shown that companion animals provide many health benefits. These include physical, mental and emotional health, as well as social interaction. Studies have shown that the presence of animals in the home reduces the risk of heart attack and lowers blood pressure. Tending to the needs of a pet provides structure for a person's day and provides purpose for older owners and caretakers.

Safe Haven has undertaken activities in addition to sheltering and rehoming cats and dogs, which are intended to assist owners and caretakers in maintaining the health and well-being of the animals they care for.

The spay/neuter clinic promotes health pet outcomes by lowering the likelihood of cancers and reducing unwanted animal behaviors. This clinic also reduces the number of unplanned births, reducing the nuisance of free-roaming animals. We have developed a robust program to provide nutritious pet food for animals cared for by those who need help with financial issues.

Providing food assistance helps keep pets in their homes where they provide needed companionship. Keeping these animals in their homes reduces pressure on overcrowded shelters and provides owners/caretakers with valuable health benefits. As one who has dealt with clinical depression for many years, I am very thankful for the amazing animals who have been a part of our family and who have provided great comfort over the years. I will share a little about them:

My wife, Lynda, and I were blessed with two dogs: Brandi, an Irish Setter, and Honey, a Golden Retriever. They had very different personalities. Brandi was athletic and insisted on playing

until she was nearly exhausted, whether catching a tennis ball or chasing a frisbee. Honey had no interest in those games, but she was always happy to accompany Lynda or myself on a walk, or travel with me to our farm.

By 2011, we had become cat people. That year we adopted Louie and Latte at Safe Haven. They were great companions until they passed away in 2023. Later that year Blueberry was adopted at Safe Haven. To say that he has a big personality would be a drastic understatement. He is often very vocal in expressing his need to be petted or to engage in play.

Please be mindful of the many positives that are associated with pet ownership when considering your support of Safe Haven as it endeavors to make resident's lives better.

Sam

Sam Smith
Board President



Sam and friend at the shelter.

Breaking News - Nellie is Home



In our last issue, we told you the story of Nellie, the little beagle Safe Haven took in when her previous owners chose not to perform life-saving surgery on her broken leg. We can now share the terrific news that Nellie has completed her rehab under the watchful eye of Foster Mom Rachel and is now thriving in her new home with Steve and Sue!

Nellie thanks each and everyone one of the eleven donors to her surgery costs, which were 100% covered by your generosity. She can now look forward to a wonderful new life full of adventures with her forever family.

Safe Haven Holds Free Adoption Days For the 1st Time

Safe Haven was awarded a \$10,000 grant from The American Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals® (ASPCA) as part of their nationwide campaign, "The Rescue Effect", to support adoption at local shelters and rescues during 2026.

To comply with the terms of the grant, Safe Haven is holding a series of no-fee adoption days that will run into the fall. Our standard adoption application and screening processes

still apply to ensure every pet finds the perfect forever home. It's best to get your application in right away!

For dates and times, visit safehavenforpets.org.



Amanda Kautz Promoted to Assistant Manager

For the first time in the history of Safe Haven, we have an assistant manager position and it has been filled by former foster coordinator, Amanda Kautz.

While she still processes foster applications and facilitates cat and dog adoptions, Amanda now helps shelter manager Jeannette with creating and updating policies and procedures, communicating with staff and volunteers, and tracks the diets, schedules, and medical needs of each animal in our care. She also takes time to enrich the lives of dogs like Fiona by taking them for walks outside of the shelter.

Next time you stop by the shelter, be sure to congratulate Amanda on her new position!



Safe Haven Out & About

For almost a year, Lola's Deli has been hosting Bingo on two Thursday evenings a month with proceeds going to Safe Haven.

To ensure that everyone is properly welcomed to the big event, volunteers have been taking Safe Haven dogs to act as greeters! On designated play nights, dog greeters arrive and doors open at 5:00 pm with a special Bingo dinner menu

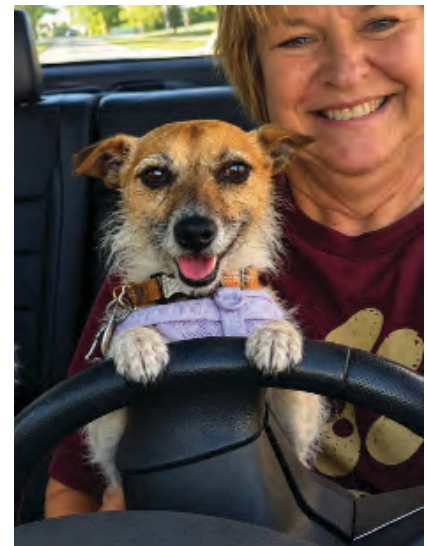
available. Bingo packs are just \$5 for 10 rounds. The final round prize is based on card sales, so the more the merrier! Lola's Deli is located at 102 N Main Street, Elizabeth, IL. Come for dinner and stay to play for a great cause! Thank you to Susan and Carrie at Lola's Deli for hosting Bingo and continuing to support Safe Haven. We appreciate you! (Must be 18 to participate.)



Lola's co-owner, Susan, visiting with Fiona.

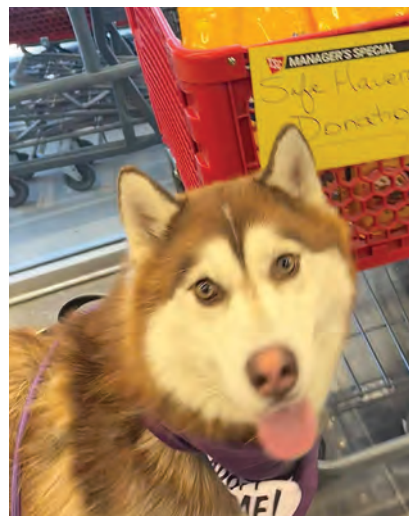


We think the new Bingo cards are pretty awesome!



Copper on her way to Bingo night with volunteer Wendy.

Meet & Greet at Tractor Supply in Galena



Some of Our Amazing Volunteers in Action!

Volunteer Hours Update

Total volunteer hours
May-August 2026:
1,838

Month with the most hours:
August/506

"Volunteers are not paid - not because they are worthless, but because they are priceless."

~ Sherry Anderson, author

"We make a living by what we get, but we make a life by what we give."

~ Sir Winston Churchill, politician

"No act of kindness, no matter how small, is ever wasted."

~ Aesop, ancient Greek storyteller



Fiona, Carol and Wendy return from a successful outing. Many of our dogs really enjoy going for car rides and walks in new surroundings.



Jane with Peanut and Trudy with Copper ready for the Tractor Supply outing. This was the 3rd year Safe Haven has taken dogs to Tractor Supply for their annual meet and greet.



Lori and Will taking their latest round of cat fosters home. Cat and dog foster homes are always needed!



Volunteer (and husband to our own Jeannette McCullum) Kevin giving Jade some love.



Volunteers Krista and Amsen, a mother/daughter team who love working with Safe Haven cats.



Al and Kim don't let a little rain stop them from coming in and walking dogs during bad weather.



Volunteer Amy shows off the golf outing tees. Amy also designed the new Lola's Bingo cards!



Meet Monserrat, our newest junior volunteer, who enjoys helping out on the cat side.

From Treasurer Dave Kizior

WAYS ALL OF US CAN SUPPORT SAFE HAVEN'S SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY

1. **Bequests:** A legacy contribution can be added to your will. A legacy contribution such as this can strengthen the financial base of Safe Haven for the future, and can take the form of cash, securities, life insurance, or physical assets such as real estate.
2. **Qualified Charitable Distribution (QCD):** QCD's are an option for taxpayers over age 70 ½ that allows them to make a donation to a qualified non-profit, 501(c)(3), with a tax free withdrawal from their retirement account. QCD's are especially advantageous after age 73, when a QCD can apply to the Required Minimum Distribution (RMD), and eliminate the income tax on that portion of the RMD.
3. **Memorials:** Safe Haven can be the beneficiary of a gift or memorial at the time of one's passing if designated by the survivor's family members.
4. **Christmas Appeal:** Consider a gift to Safe Haven during the holiday season as part of your year-end giving.
5. **Membership & Pet Sponsorships:** Donations to Safe Haven can be made monthly or yearly through our website (safehavenforpets.org) or through our Facebook Page.
6. **Golf Outing & Gala:** Participate in our seasonal, social fundraisers or consider sponsorship or silent auction items for them.

Safe Haven Thanks the 2026 Golf Outing Sponsors

Safe Haven hosted our sixth annual golf outing at Woodbine Bend June 29. This is one of our main fundraising events of the year and we thank everyone who participated, whether on the golf course or as a sponsor, and contributed to the day's success. See you in 2027!

Animal's Best Friend

Fitzgerald Family Foundation
Riley Subaru/Dubuque
Sam & Lynda Smith
Skull Valley Charity Golf Course

Sassy Cat

Edward Jones/Ashlie Stoddard

Playful Puppy

Apple River State Bank/First
Community Bank of Galena
Diane & Leonard Banas
Bauer & Fonseca, PC
Citizens State Bank
Community Bank

Grass Kickers

Dave & Debbie Kizior
Old School Saloon
Re/Max/Jackie Debes
Union-Hoermann

Felsty Kitten

Big Heart Ranch
Andrew Chesney
Choice Realty/Anne Sadler
Coldwell Banker Realty Network
Horsepower Farm, LLC
Galena Elks
Galena Square Vet Clinic
Galena VFW
Highway 20 Brewing Company

Hoskins Building Center

Ralph & Mary Jo Losey
Midwest Animal & Pest Control
Miner Insurance
Northern IL Veterinary Service
Northwest Eye Care, PC
Plager, Krug, Bauer, Rudolf & Stodden, LTD
Precision Electric
Protech Heating & Cooling
Saunders Oil Company
Stephenson Service Company
Cheryl & Tom Stine
Veterinary Associates

Free Pet Food Distribution Continues

This summer, Safe Haven has distributed \$12,000 worth of pet food to those in need. This ongoing effort is done through each local food bank in Jo Daviess County and during giveaway days at the shelter. This program has helped many individuals keep their beloved pets at home during hard times as well as given community cat caregivers some of the resources they need to help homeless animals.

The food is donated by Greater Good Charities and picked up by Safe Haven volunteers at their warehouse in Cedar Rapids, IA. It took two vehicles, driven by volunteers Carol and Ryan, to pick up the latest donation from Greater Good at their warehouse in Cedar Rapids, IA.

With Safe Haven's garage full, we were able to set up and serve consumers from the parking lot of St. Paul's Lutheran Church just down the road from the us. We appreciate their help with providing a location and advertising the distribution on their electrical sign.

The day went well. Here's what volunteer Vicki tells us: "What a wonderful experience today was! Young Jameson took charge of traffic control, and teen Luke flexed his muscles and led the way in carrying his share of the load. Us more mature players had an easier time of it because of the young legs, arms and backs!!! What a great crew! So much fun. We're pooped, but know many kitties and pups will eat well due to all of our efforts!"



Volunteer Vicki unloading the van.

Sponsor-A-Pet - Starts at Just \$10/Month!

Your monthly donation of \$10 or more helps to support one of our cats or dogs in the shelter. All major credit cards are accepted. You may cancel at anytime. Please consider joining those who make these contributions by signing up using the QR code on the back of this newsletter.

David Anderson
Stephanie Beardsley
Kathleen Behof
Karen Birkbeck
Lisa Bourrette
Steve & Trish Bianchetta
Gary Binder
Mary & Brian Brandt
Jackie Buckley
Dan & Connie Consedine
John & Kay Day
Divine Interventions
Cathy Dorwick
Bob & Lu Douglas

Edith Duncan
Steve Efken
Linda & Wilfred Enders
Andrea Garvey
David Gilliland
Larry & Karen Gorczowski
Pam Hall
Bernie & Mary Carol Harris
Debra Huso
Richard & Karen Jasper
Shari Kochman
Lucy Koropchuk
Loren Maccario
Pat & Linda Malia

Brittany & Dave Middendorf
Joseph Murnane
Tom & Wallene Neumiller
Donna Pries
James & Ulrike Rachuy
Dana Rowe
Sam & Lynda Smith
The Freckles Foundation/Jeni Pearce
Doug Troutman
Sue Walker
John & Lisa Wilhelmsen

A Few of Our Happy Tails

Latest Adoption Numbers

Dogs as of 8/15/2026

29

Cats as of 8/15/26:

47



Momma cat Fluffy and her kitten



Odie



Milly



Scout



Mary



Dot



Major



Jade

Gifts Given In Memory Of

In Memory of Mike Knapp

Kevin Knapp
Stacey Vorwald

In Memory of Moose & Munchkin Shaughnessy

Carol Kucan-Gaffin

In Memory of Susan Loring

Terry Loring

In Memory of George Nardin

Paul Hundrieser

In Memory of Janine "Jan" Zane

Diane & James Beemster
Lisa Jackson
Dianne Lorento
Marjorie Olivier

In Memory of Ann Logemann Rogers & Janet

Radabaugh Tipton
Barbara Johnson

In Memory of Aunt Polly Diddens. A huge lover of animals, especially cats. A gentle loving soul.

Will Hoeper & Lori Myers

In Memory of Millie, beloved dog of Mike & Francie Larkin

Mittie & David Den Herder

In Memory of Dr. Terrance Allen Brown

Kishore Thampy

In Memory of Lilac, 23-year-old cat

Marlene Trader

In Memory of Remi

Catherine Esser

In Memory of Maurice Bunyan

Carol & Jack Daniels

In Memory of Bernie & Mary Carol Harris's pets

Lois M. Kaiser-Genthe

In Memory of Sandie Froehlich

Susan Howell

In Memory of Bentley

Andrea Torres

Gifts Given In Honor Of

In Honor of Bitsy's 9th Birthday

Lucy Koropchuk

In Honor of Al Hendren

Long Electric & Plumbing, LTD

In Honor of Zula

Carol Bunyan

In Honor of Janine Zane

Mary & Thomas Peters

In Honor of Mary Rubel's Birthday

Jane Rubel

We try very hard to ensure that our in memory of and in honor of donations are included correctly in our newsletter.

If you made a donation and it was not included or it was misspelled, please send an email to safehavenbookkeeper1471@gmail.com and we will make sure it is corrected in the next issue.



Safe Haven
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www.safehavenforpets.org
safehaven1471@gmail.com

Make A Gift Today!

Just point your smartphone camera at the QR code and you will be taken directly to the donation page of the Safe Haven website.

Making a donation is quick and secure.
Safe Haven does not sell, share, or otherwise reveal donor information to any 3rd party.

